

I Am Here.



There are words people say because they sound beautiful.

Then there are words people spend their entire lives trying to prove.

Mine are simple.

I am here.

I am real.

I won't go anywhere.



The older I become, the less impressed I am by promises.

Not because promises are meaningless.

Because they're easy.

Presence isn't.

Showing up on ordinary days.

Answering after difficult conversations.

Remaining when life becomes inconvenient.

Listening when silence would be easier.

Those things don't happen because someone made a promise.

They happen because someone made a choice.

Again.

And again.

And again.



I don't want the people I love to wonder where they stand with me.

I don't want affection to feel conditional.

Or temporary.

Or something they have to earn every single day.

Life already asks enough from people.

Love shouldn't ask them to constantly prove they deserve it.



If I care about someone...

I hope they never have to question whether I mean it.

Not because I'll always know the right words.

I won't.

Not because I'll never make mistakes.

I will.

But because even on my worst days...

I want them to know one thing.

I'm still here.



Being here doesn't mean never leaving the room.

It means never leaving the relationship.

It means staying present through misunderstandings.

Through uncomfortable conversations.

Through seasons when life feels heavier than either of us expected.

Sometimes love isn't fixing the problem.

Sometimes love is simply refusing to disappear while we face it together.



I think everyone carries a quiet fear.

The fear that one day the people they love will decide they're too much.

Too emotional.

Too broken.

Too difficult.

Too ordinary.

I can't erase that fear.

But I can spend a lifetime giving someone evidence that they don't have to carry it alone.



Maybe that's why consistency has always mattered more to me than perfection.

Flowers eventually wilt.

Grand gestures become memories.

Words fade.

But presence...

Presence accumulates.

It becomes trust.



"I am here."

Means...

You don't have to face today alone.

"I am real."

Means...

What we're building isn't imaginary.

"I won't go anywhere."

Means...

Not forever.

Not because life never changes.

But because as long as this is ours...

I'll keep choosing it.

I'll keep choosing you.



I've learned that love isn't measured by the loudest moment.

It's measured by the quiet ones.

The ordinary mornings.

The difficult evenings.

The conversations after the arguments.

The hand that doesn't let go when letting go would be easier.

That's the kind of love I hope I give.

Not dramatic.

Reliable.



If someday someone asks me what love looks like...

I don't think I'll have a clever answer.

I'll probably just smile.

Sit beside her.

Reach for her hand.

And let my life say what my words never fully could.

I'm here.

I'm real.

And I'm not going anywhere.



— Ralph.

